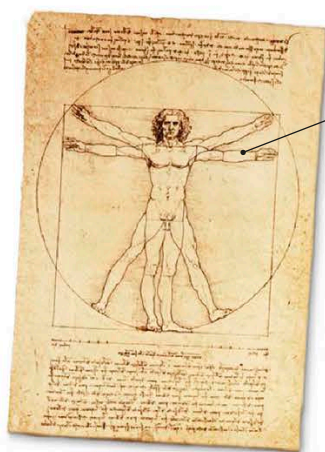




▲ USING PERSPECTIVE

Renaissance artists developed new techniques to make their paintings appear more natural, including the use of perspective to give the illusion of distance. This view of a city, called *The Ideal City*, is painted on a flat surface, but it appears to have depth as the buildings in the background become smaller and seem further away from the viewer.



The arm span is the same as the figure's height.

FACT

In 1543, Polish astronomer Nicolaus Copernicus proved that Earth revolves round the sun, rather than the other way around—a major breakthrough in our understanding of the universe.

▲ VITRUVIAN MAN

The notebooks of Italian Renaissance artist and scientist Leonardo da Vinci were filled with brilliant sketches and designs for inventions ahead of their time, such as a helicopter-like flying machine. He made this drawing, called *Vitruvian Man*, to illustrate the “perfect” proportions of the human body.



▲ THE RENAISSANCE SPREADS

From Italy, the Renaissance spread out across northern Europe. Monarchs such as King Francis I of France (reigned 1515–1547) invited Italian artists to work for them. The *Château de Chambord* (above) was built by Francis I to display his wealth and power. It included Renaissance features in its design, some of which may have been the work of Leonardo da Vinci.

DECORATIVE ARTS

Artists and craftworkers produced beautiful objects to decorate the villas and palaces of the wealthy, including bronze and marble sculptures, ceramics, jewelry, and fine metalwork. Decorative objects were often displayed in cabinets to show off the taste of the collector.



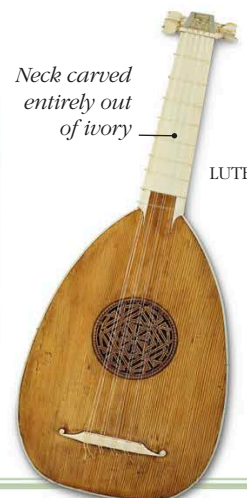
GOLD VESSEL FOR HOLDING SALT



JAR FOR MEDICINES



TERRA-COTTA WALL DECORATION



LUTE

Neck carved entirely out of ivory